

Edexcel 9BS0 — what The Business School actually covers

A specification-by-specification breakdown of how the live classroom simulation maps to Edexcel A-Level Business (9BS0), plus how the same decisions apply to AQA, BTEC and IGCSE Business at topic level.

How this works

Student layer: a plain, in-context instruction — “Set your price”, “File your VAT return”. No jargon, no distraction from the task.

Teacher / Pearson layer: the same action, tagged with its exact Edexcel 9BS0 sub-code, viewable in the teacher dashboard — so you can audit coverage against your scheme of work.

This is the only board tagged at sub-code level inside the live product today. For other boards, see “Other specifications” on page 2.

Edexcel A-Level Business 9BS0 — live in-game mapping

Theme 1 — Marketing & people

Set your price for a live product line	1.3
Research the market before you launch	1.1
Allocate your marketing budget across channels	1.4
Hire staff to build capacity	1.5

Theme 2 — Managing business activities

Choose a source of finance	2.1
Manage cash flow across the phase	2.2
File your VAT return	2.3
Read the profit and loss position	2.4

Theme 3 — Business decisions & strategy

Win the contract vs rivals	1.2 · 3.5
Respond to a market crisis	3.6
Choose a growth strategy	3.2
Set the firm's objectives	3.1

Theme 4 — Global business (expanding)

Weigh an international opportunity	4.1
------------------------------------	-----

Theme 4 is the area currently being built out — shown here as “expanding” rather than claiming full coverage.

Other specifications

Primary alignment is to Edexcel A-Level Business (9BS0), with exact sub-codes tagged inside the live product. The same underlying decisions — pricing, marketing spend, hiring, finance, VAT, growth strategy, crisis response — work as an applied classroom activity for the boards below. These are topic-level matches, not in-game sub-code tags.

Board	Where the simulation fits
AQA Business (7132 A-Level / 8132 GCSE)	Same four-theme shape as Edexcel (Marketing → Managing → Decisions/Strategy → Global) — topics map cleanly, sub-code tagging not yet built into the UI.
BTEC Business (Level 3)	Coursework/assignment-based rather than exam-spec-coded. Works well as evidence-generating practice for the Exploring Business and Finance components.
Cambridge IGCSE Business (0450)	Six-section structure — strong fit for the introductory business-concepts content (Marketing, Finance, People, Operations sections).

Teaching a different board and want the full topic map (WJEC/Eduqas, CCEA, IB Business Management, OCR H431)? Ask — we'll send the reference table.

Assessment objective coverage (Edexcel)

The simulation gives students structured opportunities to demonstrate all four assessment objectives within a single 60-minute lesson.

AO1 — Knowledge & understanding	AO2 — Application
Students use terminology — price elasticity, contribution, working capital, VAT — in the moment of use, not from a glossary.	Every pricing, hiring and finance decision is an applied use of theory in the firm's specific context.
AO3 — Analysis	AO4 — Evaluation
Cause-and-effect surfaces live: a price rise produces a measurable demand change; a missed VAT filing produces a measurable penalty.	The end-of-session reflection gives students a written record of trade-offs to evaluate in the next written task.

Sample exam question — how it lands

The most common HoD question is “yes, but how does playing actually translate to exam marks?” Here is one worked example using the standard Edexcel Paper 1 evaluation format.

EDEXCEL PAPER 1 (SECTION B) — 20-MARK STYLE

“Evaluate the extent to which a UK retailer should pass on a 20% rise in raw material costs to its customers.” (20 marks)

AO1 — During play, students used contribution, price elasticity and cash flow as live decision tools, not just textbook terms.

AO2 — In a Supply Chain Disruption event, students experienced a real cost shock mid-round and had to choose: absorb it, pass it on partially, or pass it on fully. The exam answer can draw on that lived context.

AO3 — Students saw the cause-effect first-hand: those who passed costs on fully lost market share; those who absorbed the hit lost margin. Both halves of the analysis are backed by evidence the student watched happen.

AO4 — The end-of-session reflection gives students a reference point for “in the short run ... but in the long run ...” — the evaluation construction examiners reward.